



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Guatemala. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.
What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing your background — that's a strong starting point. You're in a great position to shape your future, and Denmark offers several educational paths after primary school (folkeskole), depending on your interests, strengths, and career goals.

In Denmark, your main options after 9th or 10th grade are:

1. Gymnasiale Uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education)

These are academic paths that prepare you for higher education (university, professional bachelor, etc.)

A. STX (Almen Studentereksamen)

- Broadest and most academic.
- Strong in humanities, sciences, and social studies.
- Good if you're unsure but think university might be for you.

B. HHX (Higher Commercial Examination Programme)

- Focuses on business, economics, marketing.
- Good if you're interested in international trade, entrepreneurship, or working in business.
- Often includes internships and real-world projects.

C. HTX (Higher Technical Examination Programme)

- Focuses on technology, science, IT, and innovation.
- Great if you're interested in engineering, design, or programming.

D. HF (Higher Preparatory Examination)

- Shorter (2 years), more practical than STX.
- Good if you prefer a more hands-on approach and want quicker access to some types of higher education.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (VET - Vocational Education and Training)

These prepare you for specific jobs (plumber, carpenter, social assistant, etc.) and include paid internships.

- You start with a basic course and then go into apprenticeship.
- Can also lead to higher education (via **EUX**: a combined vocational and academic program).

Recommended if:

- You like working hands-on.
- You want to earn while you learn.
- You're interested in skilled trades or care professions.

3. Other Options

- **10th grade** (optional, gives you more time to mature or explore interests).
- **Efterskole** – a one-year boarding school where you grow personally and socially while studying.
- **International opportunities**: You're bilingual and bicultural, which is a huge strength. Consider exchange programs or international schools.

What should guide your choice?

Ask yourself:

- Do I like studying theory (math, literature, history)?
- Do I prefer doing practical work?
- Am I interested in business, tech, science, design, or social work?
- Do I want to work right after education or study at university?

Your Guatemalan Background Is a Strength

- Consider HHX if you're interested in international business or trade.
- Think about bilingual roles, interpretation, NGOs, or international relations later.
- You could bring valuable perspectives into fields like social work, education, diplomacy, or journalism.

Final Suggestions

If you're unsure:

- **Visit schools** during open house days.

- **Talk to a UU-vejleder** (educational guidance counselor) – they can help map your interests to concrete options.
 - Consider a **10th grade** or an **efterskole** year to explore yourself more deeply.
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Want help choosing between a few specific programs or schools? Feel free to tell me what you enjoy most (subjects, hobbies, dreams), and I can help narrow it down!